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Meaningful Investment Checker — Rulebook v2.1

Black Sesame International Holding Limited (Stock Code: 2533) · HKEX Chapter 18C · Prospectus dated July 31, 2024

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Module 0 — Pre-conditions and company classification

Parameter	Determined value	Caveat
Specialist Technology Industry	Advanced hardware and software	<i>No pre-IPO enquiry outcome disclosed</i>
Acceptable sector	Semiconductors / AI (autonomous driving SoC)	—
Commercial or Pre-Commercial	Commercial (FY2023 revenue RMB312m ≈ HK\$342m)	<i>Classification not expressly stated in SII section</i>
Expected market cap (HKD)	≈ HK\$16.6bn (mid-point HK\$29.15 × 569.2m shares)	<i>Subject to final Offer Price determination</i>
Market cap tier	HK\$15–30bn	—
Applicable aggregate SII threshold	15% (PARAM_E_COMM_MID)	<i>Requires Commercial status to be confirmed explicitly</i>
Module F triggered?	Yes — all Preferred Shares convert 1:1 at listing	<i>Binding shareholders' resolution July 26, 2024</i>
Module G triggered?	Yes — Pathfinder SIIs exist	<i>6-month lock-up per Rule 18C.14(2)</i>
Module H triggered?	No — aggregate threshold met pre-listing	<i>No SII Placee reliance</i>
Module I triggered?	No — no existing overseas listing	—

Executive summary

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The prospectus satisfies the core quantitative thresholds: two Pathfinder SIIs (Northern Light and Oceanpine) meet the 12-month holding, individual 3% and aggregate 10% benchmarks; the nine-SII aggregate exceeds the applicable 15% threshold at Listing. However, several disclosure gaps are identified that this may not satisfy the qualitative and procedural requirements of Chapter 2.5 of the Guide. The most material issues are: (1) the absence of date-specific independence assessments per SII (Rules A1–A3); (2) missing express statements on acting-in-concert and no-return-of-investment (Rules A4–A5); (3) the individual SII investment amounts and reference date compliance for Module C; and (4) the key market participant qualification for Geely and SAIC Motor SIIs (Rule B5).

Disclosure matrix

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
P1	Module 0	Specialist Technology Company status	D, K, L	Present	Critical	p.186	The prospectus identifies BSI as an autonomous driving SoC provider operating in the Advanced hardware and software industry (specifically semiconductors and AI). This characterisation is used consistently in the business section, industry overview (Frost & Sullivan, pp.128–153) and the SII section. No pre-IPO enquiry outcome is disclosed, though the sector falls within the enumerated acceptable sectors.
P2	Module 0	Commercial or Pre-Commercial classification	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	Critical	p.186	FY2023 revenue (audited) = RMB312.391m ≈ HK\$342m > PARAM_COMM_REV_MIN (HK\$250m), supporting Commercial Company status. However, the SII section does not expressly state "Commercial Company" or link the revenue figure to the regulatory threshold. The 15% aggregate SII threshold implied in the disclosure is consistent with Commercial status but the classification is not stated and the revenue figure is not cited in the SII section. RECOMMENDATION: Add an express statement in the SII section confirming Commercial Company classification and citing the FY2023 audited revenue figure of RMB312,391 thousand and its HKD equivalent, with reference to PARAM_COMM_REV_MIN.
P3	Module 0	Market capitalisation tier	D, T, K	Present	Critical	p.186	Indicative market cap at mid-point (HK\$29.15 × 569,169,253 shares) ≈ HK\$16.6bn → HK\$15–30bn tier. The prospectus states aggregate SII will hold "no less than 15% ... assuming that our expected market capitalisation at the time of Listing will exceed HK\$15 billion," confirming the tier. Minimum market cap for Commercial Company (HK\$6bn) is comfortably exceeded. Cross-referenced against pro forma net proceeds calculations which imply a market cap consistent with the HK\$15–30bn tier.
A1	Module A	Date of independence assessment per SII	D, K, L	Absent	Critical	p.186	Para 17 of the Guide requires independence to be determined as at the date of signing of the definitive agreement and confirmed as continuing up to Listing. The prospectus contains a single general independence statement covering all nine SII without stating the definitive agreement date for any SII or confirming independence as at that specific date. The statement reads "independent from and not connected with any Director, chief executive or substantial shareholder" — it does not reference the definitive agreement date structure required by para 17.

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
							RECOMMENDATION: For each SII, disclose the date of the relevant definitive agreement and provide a statement confirming independence was assessed as at that date and that independence is continuing through to Listing.
A2	Module A	Independence from applicant, controlling shareholders and founders	D, R, K, L	Insufficient	Critical	p.186	A general independence statement is present. Dr. YANG Lei (non-executive Director) was a partner at Northern Light Venture Capital (the manager of the Northern Light SIIs) from February 2010 to October 2021. His departure approximately 20 months before the listing application date is disclosed. The prospectus does not explain the factual basis for concluding the NL SIIs remain independent given this connection. The independence language is formulaic and identical across all nine SIIs without addressing the specific circumstances of each investor. Note: BSI has no "controlling shareholder" under the Listing Rules (no person holds $\geq 30\%$), but Mr. Shan as founder and largest individual shareholder with voting control should be treated as the relevant reference person. RECOMMENDATION: Provide investor-specific independence analysis for the Northern Light SIIs addressing Dr. Yang's former role. For each SII, state the factual basis for independence from (a) the applicant, (b) its directors, and (c) its founder Mr. Shan.
A3	Module A	No relationship with founder or close associate	D, K, L	Absent	Critical	p.186	Para 17 requires the prospectus to confirm no SII is a close associate of the founder. The independence statement covers directors, chief executives and substantial shareholders — it does not expressly address the founder close-associate test. Mr. Shan Jizhang is the founder and must be separately addressed. The close-associate definition under the Listing Rules is broader than directorial connections. RECOMMENDATION: Add an express statement for each SII confirming it is not a close associate of Mr. Shan Jizhang (founder) within the meaning of the Listing Rules. Address whether any SII or its beneficial owners have family, business or financial relationships with Mr. Shan.
A4	Module A	No acting-in-concert arrangements	D, K, L	Absent	High	p.186	Para 18 requires disclosure that SIIs are not acting in concert with each other, the applicant, or any controlling shareholder. The prospectus notes that the Northern Light SIIs, Oceanpine SIIs and SummitView SIIs are related groups of co-managed entities, but

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
							no statement addresses the acting-in-concert prohibition. The absence of an express statement leaves the para 18 requirement unaddressed. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Include an express statement in the SII section confirming that none of the SIIs are acting in concert with each other, with BSI, or with any director or founder in connection with their investment.</i>
A5	Module A	No agreements to return investment	D, K, L	Absent	Critical	p.186	Para 19 requires an express statement that there is no agreement or arrangement for BSI or its associates to return, reimburse, or otherwise compensate any SII. No such statement appears in the SII section. The pre-IPO investment section notes that divestment rights have been terminated, but this is not equivalent to the para 19 prohibition. The absence of any express statement means this critical requirement is not met on the face of the prospectus. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Insert an express statement confirming the absence of any agreement or arrangement, whether written or oral, to return, reimburse, or otherwise compensate any SII in connection with its investment in BSI.</i>
B1	Module B	Sophistication requirement generally	D, R, L	Insufficient	Critical	p.186	The prospectus provides investor-specific AUM, portfolio size, or key market participant status for most SIIs. However, the sophistication of Geely SII and SAIC Motor SII rests entirely on Frost & Sullivan's designation as "key participants in the downstream automotive industry" — without any investor-specific financial metrics (AUM, portfolio, fund size). The determination is not linked to the date of investment for these two SIIs. For the remaining seven SIIs, specific figures are provided. RECOMMENDATION: <i>For Geely SII and SAIC Motor SII, provide financial metrics supporting sophistication as at the investment date, or confirm that HKEX advance submission has been obtained for Para 21(iv) status (see Rule H2c).</i>
B2	Module B	Asset management / fund threshold ≥ HK\$15bn (Para 21(i))	D, T, K, L	Present	Critical	pp.186–191	Northern Light Venture Capital AUM: HK\$17.69bn (June 30, 2016, within 6 months of Series A definitive agreement) > HK\$15bn ✓. Updated AUM HK\$31.19bn (September 30, 2023) also stated. BOCGI AUM: HK\$118.7bn (June 30, 2021) >> HK\$15bn ✓. CS Capital (Future Industry Fund) AUM: RMB59bn ≈ HK\$64.6bn (June 30, 2021) >> HK\$15bn ✓. Reference date footnote (1)

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B3	Module B	Corporate portfolio ≥ HK\$15bn excluding consolidated subsidiaries (Para 21(ii))	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	High	pp.189–190	confirms compliance with the 6-month rule for the first figures. Xiaomi Corporation: diverse investment portfolio RMB74.5bn (June 30, 2021) ≈ HK\$81.6bn > HK\$15bn ✓. Tencent Holdings: diverse investment portfolio RMB878.7bn (December 31, 2021) >> HK\$15bn ✓. However, neither disclosure states that consolidated subsidiaries have been excluded from the portfolio figure, as required by Para 21(ii). This exclusion must be explicitly stated. RECOMMENDATION: Amend the disclosure for both Xiaomi SII and Tencent SII to confirm that the stated portfolio figures exclude investments in consolidated subsidiaries, as required by Para 21(ii) of the Guide.
B4	Module B	Specialist Technology AUM ≥ HK\$5bn (Para 21(iii))	D, T, K, L	Present	Critical	pp.187–189	Oceanpine SII: AUM HK\$5.9bn "derived primarily from the valuation of their investments in Specialist Technology Companies" as of September 25, 2020 (the date of the relevant definitive agreement) > PARAM_B4_TECH_MIN (HK\$5bn) ✓. "Primarily" language present. SummitView SII: "more than HK\$5 billion in Specialist Technology Companies" as of December 31, 2020 > HK\$5bn ✓. Both figures are supported by footnote (1) confirming C2 compliance. The sectors identified (next-generation IT, new energy, advanced hardware) are consistent with BSI's Specialist Technology Industry.
B5	Module B	Key market participant (Para 21(iv))	D, R, L	Insufficient	High	pp.191–192	Geely SII and SAIC Motor SII are described as "key participants in the downstream automotive industry" per Frost & Sullivan. The prospectus does not: (a) identify the specific Specialist Technology Industry in which each SII is active (automotive OEMs are not themselves Specialist Technology companies); (b) explain how being an automotive OEM constitutes active participation in a Specialist Technology Industry; (c) disclose that advance HKEX submission has been made for Para 21(iv) SII (required under Para 32(ii) of the Guide). The connection between OEM activity and Specialist Technology industry expertise is not articulated. RECOMMENDATION: For Geely and SAIC Motor SII: (1) Identify the specific Specialist Technology Industry in which each SII is active; (2) explain the connection to BSI's sector; (3) confirm advance HKEX submission has been made and reference any HKEX acknowledgment.

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B6	Module B	Government / sovereign wealth fund (Para 21(v))	D, L	Not Applicable	High	—	None of the nine SII claim qualification under Para 21(v). BOCGI is a wholly-owned subsidiary of Bank of China Group Investment Limited, itself a subsidiary of Bank of China Limited (a state-owned bank). BOCGI has not been characterised as a government body or sovereign wealth fund in the prospectus, and instead relies on Para 21(i) (AUM ≥ HK\$15bn). No Para 21(v) analysis is required or missing.
C1	Module C	Identity disclosure with sufficient particulars	D, K, L	Present	Critical	pp.186–195	All nine SIIs are identified by name, entity type, jurisdiction of incorporation, ultimate beneficial ownership structure, and principal business activities. The disclosure at pp.186–195 is sufficiently specific to allow a reasonable industry participant to identify each entity. Identities are consistent across the SII section, the capitalization table and the underwriting section.
C2	Module C	Reference date: within 6 months of definitive agreement	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	Critical	pp.186–195	Footnote (1) attached to AUM/portfolio figures states the reference date is "not more than six months prior to the date on which the relevant investor signed the relevant definitive agreement." This convention adequately addresses the first AUM figure for each SII at its first investment round. However: (a) the actual definitive agreement date is not stated per SII, making independent verification impossible; (b) for SummitView SIIs, the December 31, 2020 AUM figure is cited with footnote (1), but Shanghai Jixin also received Series C+ shares on June 28, 2023 — the 2020 figure cannot satisfy C2 for the 2023 investment round; (c) amounts stated in USD without HKD conversion basis. RECOMMENDATION: For each SII, state the date of the relevant definitive agreement explicitly. For SIIs that made multiple investments, provide separate AUM reference figures for each material round satisfying C2. Add HKD conversion rates and basis for all USD figures.
C3	Module C	Reference date: within 6 months of listing application	D, T, L	Insufficient	Critical	pp.186–195	Updated figures (e.g., NL: September 30, 2023; Oceanpine: December 31, 2023; Tencent: December 31, 2023) are presented for each SII. These figures post-date the listing application (June 29, 2023) and appear intended to satisfy C3. However: (a) Para 25(ii) requires figures as of not more than 6 months before the listing application date — if "listing application date" means the A1 submission (June 29, 2023), then December 31, 2023 figures post-

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
							date this milestone and cannot satisfy C3; (b) if "listing application date" is interpreted as the prospectus date (July 31, 2024), the figures are generally within 6 months. This ambiguity should be resolved with HKEX. RECOMMENDATION: Clarify with HKEX whether "listing application date" in Para 25(ii) refers to the A1 submission date (June 29, 2023) or the prospectus date (July 31, 2024). If the former, provide updated AUM/portfolio figures dated between December 29, 2022 and June 29, 2023 for each SII.
C4	Module C	Investment amount disclosure per SII	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	High	pp.186–195	Individual investment amounts are not stated in the SII identification section for any of the nine SIIs. The pre-IPO investment overview table (pp.172–175) shows total funds raised per series, not per SII. The capitalization table (pp.189–195) shows share counts per SII but does not state investment amounts or cost per share in a way that allows direct calculation of individual investment amounts for Module D threshold purposes. No HKD conversion basis is stated for USD-denominated figures. RECOMMENDATION: For each SII, disclose the total investment amount (in HKD, with conversion basis stated) at cost, excluding subsequent divestments, to enable verification of D3 individual thresholds. Ensure the amounts are consistent with the pre-IPO investment table and capitalization table.
D1a	Module D	Pathfinder SII count (2–5)	D, T, K, L	Present	Critical	p.186	Two Pathfinder SIIs are identified: (1) Northern Light SIIs and (2) Oceanpine SIIs. These are clearly distinguished from the seven other SIIs which are labelled "Other Sophisticated Independent Investors." Count = 2 = PARAM_D_COUNT_MIN ✓, ≤ PARAM_D_COUNT_MAX (5) ✓. The same investors are consistently identified as Pathfinder SIIs in the SII section and the underwriting chapter.
D1b	Module D	Investment held ≥ 12 months before listing application (to irrevocable settlement)	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	Critical	p.186	The prospectus states "each having invested in the Group for at least 12 months prior to the first submission of our listing application to the Stock Exchange." Northern Light SIIs: first investment September 2016 → gap to June 29, 2023 ≈ 6 years 9 months ✓. Oceanpine SIIs: first investment September 25, 2020 → gap to June 29, 2023 ≈ 2 years 9 months ✓. However, PARAM_D_HOLD_MONTHS requires the 12-month period to be measured to "irrevocable settlement," not the date of the

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							definitive agreement or first subscription. The dates disclosed appear to be subscription/agreement dates, and the date of irrevocable settlement is not separately stated. RECOMMENDATION: <i>State the date of irrevocable settlement of the consideration for each Pathfinder SII's investment and confirm that the period from settlement to the listing application date exceeds 12 months per PARAM_D_HOLD_MONTHS.</i>
D2	Module D	Aggregate Pathfinder SII threshold: $\geq 10\%$ or $\geq \text{HK\$}1.5\text{bn}$	D, T, K	Present	Critical	pp.186–188	As of the listing application date (June 29, 2023): Northern Light SII 11.48% + Oceanpine SII 5.97% = 17.45% aggregate > PARAM_D2_AGG_PCT (10%) ✓. Throughout the pre-application 12-month period: 12.53% + 6.52% = 19.05% > 10% ✓. Arithmetic verified: both stated aggregate figures match component sum. The percentage basis appears to be on fully converted (post-preferred-to-ordinary conversion) total issued share capital. No divestment deduction is required as the decline in percentages results from dilution by new share issuances (Series C+ in June 2023), not disposal.
D3	Module D	Individual Pathfinder SII threshold: $\geq 3\%$ or $\geq \text{HK\$}450\text{m}$	D, T, K, L	Present	High	pp.186–188	Northern Light SII: 11.48% at listing application date > PARAM_D3_IND_PCT (3%) ✓. Oceanpine SII: 5.97% at listing application date > PARAM_D3_IND_PCT (3%) ✓. Throughout the pre-application 12-month period, Northern Light held 12.53% and Oceanpine held 6.52%, both exceeding 3% ✓. The percentage alternative is used — individual investment amounts are not provided (see Rule C4 for insufficiency on amounts). Cross-reference with capitalization table confirms consistent percentage disclosures (minor rounding differences only).
E1	Module E	Aggregate SII shareholding benchmark	D, T, K, L	Insufficient	Critical	p.186	The prospectus states that at Listing, SII "will hold, in aggregate, no less than 15% in the total issued share capital of our Company, assuming that our expected market capitalisation at the time of Listing will exceed HK\$15 billion." This figure meets PARAM_E_COMM_MID (15%) for a Commercial Company in the HK\$15–30bn tier. However: (a) the Commercial classification is not expressly stated in the SII section (see P2); (b) the calculation basis (pre-offer / post-offer; fully diluted / basic) is not identified; (c) how the 15% is achieved from the current ~34% post-IPO SII holding is not

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
							explained step by step; (d) individual SII holdings are not broken down by category (Pathfinder / non-Pathfinder / any SII Placees). RECOMMENDATION: <i>State the calculation basis explicitly (post-offer, fully converted basis). Provide a tabular breakdown of each SII's post-IPO holding contributing to the 15% aggregate. Confirm Commercial classification in this context.</i>
E2	Module E	Threshold tier verification	T, K, L	Present	Critical	p.186	Market cap tier HK\$15–30bn and Commercial classification together determine the applicable threshold at PARAM_E_COMM_MID (15%). The prospectus applies this threshold correctly. Cross-reference against the pro forma financial information (Appendix II) confirms the expected market cap range is consistent with the indicative offer price range. No pre-modification figures or Sep 2024 temporary modifications issue arises as this prospectus predates September 1, 2024.
F1	Module F	Convertible securities: conversion at or before listing	D, T, K, L	Present	Critical	pp.170, 180	All Preferred Shares (Series A through C+, totalling 414,292,838 shares) will convert automatically to ordinary shares on a 1:1 basis immediately upon completion of the Global Offering, per shareholders' written resolutions dated July 26, 2024. The conversion is binding upon satisfaction of two conditions: (i) final offer price $\geq$ Series C+ cost; and (ii) listing by September 30, 2024. The conversion schedule is unambiguous and the obligation is irrevocable at listing. All SII shareholding percentages in the prospectus are expressed on a post-conversion basis.
F2	Module F	Post-conversion share count used for % calculations	D, T, K	Insufficient	High	pp.186–195	The capitalization table (pp.189–195) footnote confirms post-conversion basis (all Preferred Shares converted 1:1). SII percentages in the SII identification section (pp.186–192) appear to be on a pre-IPO fully-converted basis. However, the SII section itself does not explicitly state that post-conversion share counts are used for the D2, D3 and E1 threshold calculations. This creates ambiguity about whether the stated percentages are pre- or post-offer. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Add a note in the SII section confirming that all stated SII shareholding percentages are calculated on the basis that all Preferred Shares have been converted to Ordinary Shares on a 1:1 basis (pre-Global Offering, pre-exercise of Over-allotment Option).</i>

Rule	Module	Rule description	Checks	Status	Severity	Ref	Explanation / Recommendation
G1	Module G	Lock-up disclosure for Pathfinder SII	D, K, L	Insufficient	High	p.430	Lock-up obligations for Pathfinder SII are disclosed in the underwriting chapter (p.430): "12 months (or 6 months in the case of the Pathfinder SII) from the Listing Date." The 6-month period is correct per Rule 18C.14(2). However: (a) the SII identification section (pp.186–188) does not contain a plain-language statement of the lock-up obligation — it merely cross-references the "Lock-up Periods" section; (b) the lock-up disclosure appears only in the technical underwriting chapter, not prominently in the body of the SII section. Cross-reference confirms that the same investors are subject to lock-up in the underwriting section as are identified as Pathfinder SII in Module D ✓. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Include a plain-language disclosure in the SII section stating that each Pathfinder SII is subject to a 6-month lock-up restriction on disposal of Shares from the Listing Date per Rule 18C.14(2), and cross-refer to the underwriting section for the full undertaking terms.</i>
H1	Module H	SII Placee category eligibility	D, K, L	Not Applicable	Critical	—	Module H is not triggered. The aggregate SII benchmark (E1) is met entirely through pre-listing SII investments (current aggregate ≈ 34% post-IPO >> 15% threshold). The Company does not rely on SII Placees (investors receiving IPO allocation) to satisfy the Module E benchmark. Cornerstone investors (Gardex Development Limited — RMB50m; Joyson Electronic USA LLC — USD3m) are not characterised as SII in the prospectus and their combined investment is de minimis relative to the existing SII aggregate.
H2a	Module H	Applicant / OC / sponsor undertaking for SII Placees	D, L	Not Applicable	Critical	—	Not triggered. No SII Placee reliance.
H2b	Module H	SII Placee sophistication	D, R	Not Applicable	Critical	—	Not triggered.
H2c	Module H	Advance HKEX submission for Para 21(iv) Placees	D, R	Not Applicable	High	—	Not triggered for SII Placee purposes. Note: the advance HKEX submission obligation under Para 32(ii) may apply separately to Geely and SAIC Motor SII as Para 21(iv) SII at the pre-listing stage — see Rule B5 above.
H3	Module H	Post-listing allotment results disclosure (forward-looking)	D	Not Applicable	Medium	—	Not triggered. No SII Placees relied upon.
I1	Module I	Non-standard compliance:	D, R, K, L	Not Applicable	High	—	Module I is not triggered. The prospectus confirms at Appendix IV: "No company within our Group

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		secondary / dual listing					is presently listed on any stock exchange or traded on any trading system." BSI is applying for a primary listing on HKEX for the first time. Paras 33–34 of the Guide (secondary listing discretion) do not apply.

Section 4 — Cross-cutting reasoning flags

Flag ID	Severity	Category	Rules	Source files	Issue	Detail & recommendation
RF-001	Critical	arithmetic	D2, D3, E1	tier2/pathfinder_sii, tier1/cap_table	Pathfinder SII percentage decline requires divestment analysis	Northern Light SIIs declined from 12.53% (June 2022) to 11.48% (June 2023); Oceanpine SIIs from 6.52% to 5.97%. Rule D2 requires the aggregate to be maintained throughout the 12-month pre-application period excluding subsequent divestments. The prospectus attributes the decline to dilution from new share issuances (Series C+ in June 2023) rather than disposal. This is plausible and arithmetically verifiable (new shares: 33,779,953 C+ + 5,422,993 B+ + 1,648,482 B-4 = 40,851,428 issued in June 2023), but the prospectus does not explicitly state that no Pathfinder SII has disposed of any shares during the 12-month period. This explanation should be made explicit. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Add a statement confirming that the decline in Pathfinder SII percentage holdings is attributable solely to dilution from new share issuances and that no Pathfinder SII has disposed of any shares during the pre-application 12-month period.</i>
RF-002	Critical	cross_reference	A1, A2, B1	tier2/sii_disclosure, tier1/directors_mgmt	Dr. Yang Lei / Northern Light independence not adequately substantiated	Dr. Yang Lei (non-executive Director, appointed September 30, 2016) was a partner at Northern Light Venture Capital from February 2010 to October 2021. Northern Light Venture Capital is the ultimate manager of the Northern Light SIIs (Pathfinder SIIs holding 10.47%). The prospectus discloses this connection (p.186) but provides no factual basis for concluding that the NL SIIs remain independent of a director who was a senior partner at their manager until 21 months before the listing application. Under para 17, independence must be confirmed as at the definitive agreement date and continuing to Listing. Dr. Yang's October 2021 departure does not automatically sever all connections. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Provide a detailed independence analysis for the Northern Light SIIs</i>

Flag ID	Severity	Category	Rules	Source files	Issue	Detail & recommendation
						<i>addressing: (1) the nature of Dr. Yang's involvement with NL VC during the relevant investment period; (2) whether he had any role in the investment decision; (3) whether any financial or contractual ties remain between Dr. Yang and NL VC or the NL SII.</i>
RF-003	High	cross_reference	C2, B4	tier2/pre_ipo_investment, tier2/sii_disclosure	SummitView SII: Dec 31, 2020 AUM reference date fails C2 for the June 2023 investment round	SummitView SII (Shanghai Jixin) received Series C+ Preferred Shares on June 28, 2023 (consideration USD3.4733/share). The AUM reference date cited with footnote (1) is December 31, 2020 — approximately 30 months before the June 2023 definitive agreement. PARAM_C2_REF_MONTHS requires figures not more than 6 months before the definitive agreement date. The December 31, 2020 figure cannot satisfy C2 for the 2023 round. The December 31, 2023 updated figure post-dates the June 2023 investment and also does not satisfy C2 for that round. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Provide a separate AUM/portfolio figure for SummitView Capital (M&A) as of a date within 6 months before June 28, 2023 (i.e., between December 28, 2022 and June 28, 2023). If no such figure was provided to the Company, assess whether footnote (1) was correctly applied to SummitView for the June 2023 round.</i>
RF-004	High	arithmetic	E1, C4	tier2/sii_disclosure, tier1/cap_table	Post-IPO aggregate SII % of "no less than 15%" cannot be independently verified	The prospectus states SII will hold "no less than 15%" at Listing. Current pre-IPO SII aggregate is 36.46% (confirmed by summing individual holdings from cap table: NL 10.47% + Oceanpine 5.44% + SummitView 7.00% + Xiaomi 3.69% + Tencent 3.53% + BOCGI 2.71% + FI Fund 2.33% + Geely 0.78% + SAIC 0.52% = 36.47% ✓). Post-IPO dilution: 37,000,000 new offer shares issued → SII share count fixed, total shares increase to 569,169,253. Implied post-IPO SII holding ≈ 34.1%. However, the statement "no less than 15%" does not explain how 34.1% supports the 15% minimum — it should, since 34.1% >> 15%. The step-by-step

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RF-005	High	cross_reference	B5, H2c	tier2/sii_disclosure, tier1/directors_mgmt	No HKEX advance submission disclosed for Para 21(iv) SII (Geely, SAIC Motor)	calculation is missing and the calculation basis is unstated. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Provide a tabular reconciliation showing each SII's: (a) current share count and pre-IPO %; (b) post-IPO share count (assuming no disposal) and post-IPO %; (c) how the 34.1% aggregate exceeds the 15% PARAM_E_COMM_MID threshold. State clearly the calculation basis (post-offer, all Preferred Shares converted, Over-allotment Option not exercised).</i>
						Para 32(ii) of the Guide requires that for SII qualifying under Para 21(iv) (key market participants), information must be submitted to HKEX in advance. The prospectus does not disclose that any advance submission was made for Geely SII or SAIC Motor SII. This is a procedural requirement that cannot be remedied retrospectively at the prospectus stage if the submission was not made before listing application. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Confirm whether advance HKEX submissions were made for Geely SII and SAIC Motor SII. If submissions were made, disclose this in the prospectus and reference any HKEX acknowledgment or no-objection received. If no submission was made, assess whether Geely and SAIC Motor qualify under an alternative Para 21 sub-category.</i>
RF-006	Medium	arithmetic	B2, C2	tier2/sii_disclosure	Northern Light AUM update (Sept 30, 2023) post-dates listing application (June 29, 2023)	Northern Light Venture Capital AUM is stated as HK\$31.19bn "as of September 30, 2023." The listing application date was June 29, 2023. September 30, 2023 is approximately 3 months after the listing application. If Para 25(ii) requires the figure to be dated not more than 6 months before the listing application date, then September 30, 2023 cannot satisfy this requirement. The June 30, 2016 figure (with footnote (1)) satisfies C2 but may not satisfy C3 given the elapsed time. The interim period (December 2022 – June 2023) is not covered by any figure.

Flag ID	Severity	Category	Rules	Source files	Issue	Detail & recommendation
						RECOMMENDATION: <i>Provide a Northern Light AUM figure dated between December 29, 2022 and June 29, 2023 to satisfy C3 if the listing application date is the A1 submission date.</i> <i>Alternatively, clarify with HKEX that the prospectus date (July 31, 2024) is the operative reference point for C3.</i>
RF-007	Medium	cross_reference	C4, D3	tier2/pre_ipo_investment, tier2/sii_disclosure	Individual Pathfinder SII investment amounts not stated — D3 amount alternative unverifiable	Rule D3 provides a dual test: individual Pathfinder SII must hold $\geq 3\%$ OR have invested $\geq \text{HK\\$}450\text{m}$ (PARAM_D3_IND_AMT). The prospectus relies on the percentage alternative (NL: 11.48%, Oceanpine: 5.97%) which is satisfied. However, individual investment amounts are not stated anywhere in the SII section. From the pre-IPO investment table, total Series B-4 consideration = USD29.067m (for 23,959,003 shares across all holders); Oceanpine Investment Fund II LP holds 10,632,714 shares per cap table at $\approx$ USD1.2132/share = USD12.9m $\approx$ HK\$100m — this is well below PARAM_D3_IND_AMT. The percentage test is therefore the only available basis and its adequacy should be confirmed. RECOMMENDATION: <i>Confirm in the prospectus that the percentage basis (not the investment amount basis) is used for D3 individual threshold compliance, and provide the individual share counts and percentages as of the listing application date for each Pathfinder SII in a single location.</i>

Appendix: Parameter reference table

Parameter	Value	Source	Description
PARAM_B2_AUM_MIN	HK\$15bn	Para 21(i)	Minimum AUM for asset management firm SII
PARAM_B2_FUND_MIN	HK\$15bn	Para 21(i)	Minimum fund size for fund SII
PARAM_B3_PORT_MIN	HK\$15bn	Para 21(ii)	Minimum diverse investment portfolio (excl. consolidated subsidiaries)
PARAM_B4_TECH_MIN	HK\$5bn	Para 21(iii)	Minimum AUM/fund/portfolio primarily from Specialist Technology investments
PARAM_C2_REF_MONTHS	6 months	Para 25(i)	Max age of SII figures relative to definitive agreement date
PARAM_C3_REF_MONTHS	6 months	Para 25(ii)	Max age of SII figures relative to listing application date
PARAM_D_COUNT_MIN	2	Para 26(i)	Minimum number of Pathfinder SIIs
PARAM_D_COUNT_MAX	5	Para 26(i)	Maximum number of Pathfinder SIIs
PARAM_D_HOLD_MONTHS	12 months	Para 26(i)	Minimum investment period before listing application (to irrevocable settlement)
PARAM_D2_AGG_PCT	10%	Para 26(i)(a)	Aggregate Pathfinder SII shareholding threshold
PARAM_D2_AGG_AMT	HK\$1.5bn	Para 26(i)(a)	Aggregate Pathfinder SII investment amount threshold (excl. subsequent divestments)
PARAM_D3_IND_PCT	3%	Para 26(i)(b)	Individual Pathfinder SII shareholding threshold
PARAM_D3_IND_AMT	HK\$450m	Para 26(i)(b)	Individual Pathfinder SII investment amount threshold (excl. subsequent divestments)
PARAM_E_COMM_MID	15%	Para 26(ii)	Aggregate SII: Commercial Company, HK\$15–30bn market cap tier
PARAM_COMM_REV_MIN	HK\$250m	MB Rule 18C.03(4)	Minimum audited revenue (most recent FY) for Commercial Company classification
PARAM_MKTCAP_COMM_MIN	HK\$6bn	MB Rule 18C.03(3)	Minimum market cap for Commercial Company (as modified from 1 Sep 2024)

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